



What is Sonoma?

Sonoma is the code name for the second generation of the mobile Centrino notebook platform. The platform includes a Pentium M processor, the chipset and the Wi-Fi card.

How does Sonoma improve over the original Centrino platform?

The Pentium M processor now has a front-side bus increase from 400 MHz to 533 MHz. There is now support for dual-channel DDR2 memory and graphics support for the PCI-Express bus architecture. The chipset is new and has been code-named Alviso. The Centrino's integrated graphics has been upgraded by including the Intel Graphics Media Accelerator 900—the first DirectX 9.0 integrated graphics solution for notebooks. There will also be the newly-released Intel PRO/Wireless 2915ABG network connection.

Who released Sonoma?

As a successor to the Centrino platform, Sonoma was, naturally, released by Intel.

Why do we need Sonoma?

The answer is performance. Support for PCI-Express had to be brought in to Intel's mobile platform at some stage. Intel is touting Sonoma and the accompanying Alviso chipset as key breakthroughs in mobile performance and functionality, especially in areas such as digital media processing.

When Sonoma released?

Sonoma was released on 19 January 2005.

Where can I find a notebook that has support for Sonoma?

Intel expects system builders and OEMs to offer as many as 150 notebook models based on the Sonoma release. For example, Toshiba unveiled its latest tablet PC at the 2005 CES. The new Toshiba R15-S822 that launches in February includes support for Sonoma.

GADGET GLUTTONY

CES 2005: Setting The Stage For New Ideas

With over 140,000 attendees from 115 countries witnessing the introduction of thousands of new products and technologies from more than 2,500 exhibitors, the Consumer Electronics Show (CES) that ended in Las Vegas on January 9, lived up to its billing, and proved to be the biggest stage for new products on earth!

The four-day event saw executives from consumer technology, broadcasting, cable, motion picture and numerous other industries converge in Las Vegas to hear from technology industry visionaries and view a showcase of hot new products and trends in audio, accessories, home networking, mobile electronics, video and wireless equipment.

The 2005 edition also set several major show records including number of attendees (1,42,585, subject to audit), exhibitors (2,550) and exhibit space (1.531 million net square feet). International attendance

also grew to more than 23,028, up from 18,000 at the 2004 edition.

Featuring a broad array of exciting product and technology introductions and announcements, many of which provide consumers with unprecedented control over when, where and how they watch movies, listen to music, view their digital photos and access other information, education and entertainment content.

Showing the strength of the transition to High Definition Television (HDTV), the show featured the latest developments in display technologies and a variety of products and innovations that build upon HDTV.

In addition to being a product showplace, the 2005 edition included a star-studded array of industry luminaries delivering speeches and participating in over 350 conference sessions.

Speakers included Microsoft chairman and chief software architect Bill Gates, Craig Barrett, CEO, Intel Corporation, Ron Garriques, executive VP, Motorola, Carly Fiorina, chairperson, HP and Rich Templeton, president and CEO, Texas Instruments.

Some of the most noteworthy launches at the show were:

TV and Video: Sling Media's Slingbox that lets you actually redirect live or

PVR-recorded television to a wireless computer and Samsung's 80-inch plasma flat TV that earned them the bragging rights at the show!

Media Devices: Belkin TuneStage that enables iPods to wirelessly stream music to home stereos and simultaneously serve as a remote control, Archos Portable Media Assistant PMA 430 that has a 30 GB hard drive and can screen movies from TV, DVD and VCR and Olympus' M:robe 500 and 100 MP3 players with touch-screen, camera and 20 GB (5 GB in the M:robe 100) hard drives.

Gaming: Gizmondo unveiled an eponymous portable gaming device that's a Swiss Army Knife among handheld consoles being an on-the-go gaming platform delivering wireless text messaging and e-mail, GPS capabilities, a digital camera, and a portable video player.

Telephony: Samsung, LG and BenQ launched new smart phones (some with a 2-megapixel camera), Netgear Pre-N launched their Wireless Router while Corinex's Internet Video Phone.

Notebook: Toshiba R15-S822, the first Sonoma-enabled notebook.

Software: Meedio, a company that's been working diligently on a software alternative to Windows Media Centre, released a digital video recorder (DVR) package called Meedio TV.

Photography: Kodak's EasyShare One, their first Wi-Fi enabled camera, Pentax's Optio WP, a waterproof digital camera, Minolta Magiolor, a PictBridge 1.0 compliant photo-friendly laser (yes, laser) printer.

Home Theatres: Philips launched its Pronto-branded touch-screen controllers. ■

Compiled by Meera Vankipuram, Preethi Chamikutty, Ahmed Shaikh, Ram Mohan Rao and Aditya Kuber



Lexar's new digital music player that was launched at CES 2005